

NEPAL

The cold mountain air and rugged terrain of Nepal are ideal for producing full-flavored, complex teas. While black tea is most widely cultivated, green, white, and oolong teas are also produced.

Tea production is relatively new to Nepal, where there are around 85 plantations and several small farms. Most of the farmers are smallholders who sell their leaves to central factories for processing.

Though large tea plantations mostly produce CTC

teas (see p21), some of the smaller farms produce excellent orthodox tea. Unlike black teas grown at lower elevations, Himalayan black teas do not fully oxidize because the high altitude at which they are processed causes the leaves to dry out during withering. The finished leaf will include flecks of green among the dark leaves and, although light in color, the liquor will have the recognizable rich taste of black tea.



Nepali black tea is grown in the eastern mountainous regions of the island.

NEPAL KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE OF WORLD PRODUCTION: **0.4%**

MAIN TYPES: **BLACK, GREEN, OOLONG**

FAMOUS FOR:
INNOVATING A YOUNG TEA INDUSTRY, USING
SMALL TEA FARM COOPERATIVES

HARVEST:
FIRST FLUSH
MARCH-APRIL

MONSOON FLUSH
JUNE-SEPTEMBER

AUTUMN FLUSH
OCTOBER

ELEVATION:
HIGH

DHANKUTA

Dhankuta shares the same terroir as Ilam and neighboring Darjeeling.

ILAM VALLEY

Located at the eastern end of the country, bordering Darjeeling, this is the largest tea-growing area in Nepal.

KEY



NOTABLE TEA-PRODUCING REGIONS



AREA OF PRODUCTION